

I. EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

A. Weekly Delta This reporting period highlights significant advancements across Twitch and YouTube Live, primarily centered on enhancing creator monetization, viewer engagement, and content discoverability. Twitch has rolled out Dual Format and 2K streaming, directly addressing the mobile-first consumption trend, alongside expanding interactive Bit features (Combos) and broadening monetization access for Affiliates (Bounty Board, Streamer-Led Promotions). YouTube Live has aggressively focused on discoverability with "Live Rings" and "Cross-Channel Live Redirects," while introducing new interactive content formats like "Playables on Live" and streamlining premium content delivery with "Public to Members-Only Livestream" transitions. The consistent theme is a strategic push to empower creators with more tools to earn and engage, while simultaneously improving the viewer experience and platform stickiness.

B. Trend Summary 1. **Convergence of Formats:** Both Twitch and YouTube are actively embracing and integrating vertical video formats (Twitch's Dual Format streaming) alongside traditional horizontal, signaling a strong response to TikTok's influence and the mobile-first viewing paradigm. 2. **Creator-First Monetization:** Platforms are intensifying efforts to provide diverse and accessible monetization avenues for creators of all sizes. This includes empowering creators to run their own promotions (Twitch), expanding sponsorship opportunities to Affiliates, and offering flexible premium content options (YouTube's members-only streams). This trend is a direct competitive response to platforms offering aggressive revenue splits. 3. **Enhanced Engagement & Gamification:** Interactive features are becoming more sophisticated. Twitch's Combos are evolving into a more rewarding, gamified experience, while YouTube's "Playables on Live" introduces integrated gaming to boost viewer participation and watch time. 4. **Discovery as a Core Battleground:** YouTube explicitly prioritizes discoverability with features like "Live Rings" and "Cross-Channel Live Redirects," recognizing that helping viewers find content is paramount for growth and creator retention. This remains the biggest unsolved problem in live streaming. 5. **AI Integration for Creator Workflow:** Early signals from YouTube point to AI-driven tools (e.g., AI-generated highlights) aimed at reducing creator workload and optimizing content for broader reach.

C. Competitor Copycat Opportunities 1. **From Twitch:** * **Streamer-Led Promotions:** The ability for creators to independently initiate and manage platform-supported promotions (e.g., subathons) offers a powerful tool for community-driven monetization that competitors could adopt. * **Advanced Gamified Interactions (Combos):** Deeper, visually dynamic, and community-driven interactive elements tied to support could be replicated to increase viewer participation and revenue. 2. **From YouTube Live:** * **Playables on Live:** Integrating a library of interactive games directly into live streams provides a novel engagement mechanism that could significantly boost watch time and creator content diversity. * **Live Rings:** A simple, yet effective visual cue for live channels directly on profile pictures could be a powerful discovery tool for any platform. * **Cross-Channel Live Redirects:** Allowing creators to redirect audiences to *other* channels fosters a more interconnected ecosystem and supports collaborative growth, a feature that could greatly

benefit platforms like Twitch or Kick. * **Seamless Public-to-Members-Only Transitions:** The ability to switch content exclusivity mid-stream without disruption is a strong feature for membership-based monetization.

II. PLATFORM INTELLIGENCE

A. Twitch

Engagement & Retention Intelligence

- **Feature Name:** Combos Expansion
- **Category:** Engagement & Retention
- **Description:** Further enhancing the Combos feature, allowing viewers to trigger larger animations with single taps, scaled by support level. Combos are now integrated into the Cheering experience, and previous beta updates included sound alerts, real-time animations, and Activity Feed recognition.
- **Strategic Intent:** Increase viewer participation and support, gamify interaction, reward larger contributions, and create more dynamic stream moments.
- **Impact Hypothesis:** Drive higher Bit usage, create more visually engaging and interactive streams, foster community rallying around shared goals.
- **Status Tag:** ■ Feature Release
- **Feature Name:** Riot Games Bonus Gift Subs
- **Category:** Engagement & Retention / Monetization
- **Description:** Partnership with Riot Games to offer bonus gift subscriptions during specific events or promotions.
- **Strategic Intent:** Leverage popular gaming titles to drive engagement, incentivize gifting behavior, and strengthen community ties around major gaming events.
- **Impact Hypothesis:** Increased gift subscription activity, boosted viewership during partnered events, enhanced community interaction.
- **Status Tag:** ■ Feature Release
- **Feature Name:** Twitch Clips Algorithm Update
- **Category:** Engagement & Retention / Discovery
- **Description:** An update to the algorithm governing the discoverability and distribution of Twitch clips. Specifics are not detailed in the raw intelligence.
- **Strategic Intent:** Improve content discoverability, extend the lifecycle of stream moments, and drive traffic back to live channels or VODs.
- **Impact Hypothesis:** Increased reach for popular clips, better content exposure for creators, potential for viral growth.
- **Status Tag:** ■ Feature Release

Monetization Intelligence

- **Feature Name:** Streamer-Led Promotions
- **Category:** Monetization
- **Description:** Creators are now able to run their own promotions, such as subathons or anniversary events, with platform support. This feature was launched in June 2025.
- **Strategic Intent:** Empower creators with greater control over their monetization events, increase creator revenue, and foster community engagement around specific channel milestones.
- **Impact Hypothesis:** Higher subscription numbers during promotional periods, increased creator loyalty, diversified revenue streams for streamers.
- **Status Tag:** ■ Feature Release
- **Feature Name:** Bounty Board Expansion
- **Category:** Monetization
- **Description:** Expansion of the Bounty Board program to include more advertisers and third-party offers. Campaigns are being integrated alongside other sponsorship offers and are rolling out to all monetizing streamers, including Affiliates.
- **Strategic Intent:** Broaden monetization opportunities for a wider range of creators, simplify sponsorship management, and make brand deals more accessible.
- **Impact Hypothesis:** Increased creator earnings from sponsorships, more accessible brand deals for smaller creators, improved platform value proposition for monetizing streamers.
- **Status Tag:** ■ Feature Release
- **Feature Name:** Prime Subs on iOS App
- **Category:** Monetization / Engagement
- **Description:** Viewers can now utilize their Prime Subscriptions directly within the most recent version of the Twitch iOS mobile application.
- **Strategic Intent:** Improve user experience for mobile Prime subscribers, remove friction for supporting creators on iOS devices, and encourage Prime Sub redemption.
- **Impact Hypothesis:** Potentially higher Prime Sub redemption rates on mobile, better mobile engagement for Prime users, increased creator revenue from Prime Subs.
- **Status Tag:** ■ Feature Release

Streaming Infrastructure & Tech Evolution

- **Feature Name:** Dual Format and 2K Streaming
- **Category:** Streaming Infrastructure & Tech

- **Description:** Introduction of "Dual Format" streaming, allowing creators to stream in both horizontal and vertical orientations simultaneously, alongside support for 2K video quality. Announced at TwitchCon Rotterdam 2026.
- **Strategic Intent:** Compete with mobile-first platforms (e.g., TikTok, YouTube Shorts/Live vertical), improve video quality, cater to diverse viewing habits, and enhance creator flexibility for multi-platform content.
- **Impact Hypothesis:** Increased mobile viewership, better creator flexibility in content production, enhanced viewing experience for a broader audience, improved competitive standing in the mobile streaming market.
- **Status Tag:** ■ Feature Release

Competitive & Strategic Intelligence

- **Feature Name:** Enforcement Update
- **Category:** Competitive & Strategic
- **Description:** Updates to how Community Guideline violations are enforced on the platform. Specifics are not detailed in the raw intelligence.
- **Strategic Intent:** Foster a safer and more inclusive environment, build authentic connections, and maintain platform integrity.
- **Impact Hypothesis:** Improved user trust and safety, potentially reduced toxic behavior, enhanced brand reputation.
- **Status Tag:** ■ Feature Release

Leak / Rumour / Early Signal Detection

- **Feature Name:** No More Affiliate Program
- **Category:** Competitive & Strategic
- **Description:** A rumor circulating that the Twitch Affiliate Program may be abolished. This contradicts official announcements indicating an *expansion* of features for Affiliates (e.g., Bounty Board access).
- **Strategic Intent:** (N/A - Rumour)
- **Impact Hypothesis:** (N/A - Rumour)
- **Status Tag:** ■ Rumour/Leak

B. YouTube Live

Engagement & Retention Intelligence

- **Feature Name:** Playables on Live
- **Category:** Engagement & Retention
- **Description:** Creators can now play from a library of 75+ lightweight, interactive games (e.g., Angry Birds Showdown, Words of Wonders) directly on their live streams, interacting with their audience via chat. Streams can be monetized like any other broadcast.
- **Strategic Intent:** Increase interactivity and watch time, provide a new content format for creators, leverage the existing Playables library, and attract a broader audience interested in casual interactive content.
- **Impact Hypothesis:** Higher engagement metrics, new monetization avenues for game-focused streams, increased viewer stickiness, and diversified content offerings.
- **Status Tag:** ■ Feature Release
- **Feature Name:** Live Q&A with Viewers
- **Category:** Engagement & Retention
- **Description:** A feature allowing viewers to ask questions in real-time during a live stream. Answered queries are temporarily pinned to the top of the live chat window.
- **Strategic Intent:** Increase real-time interaction, make chat more structured and engaging, and facilitate direct communication between creators and their audience.
- **Impact Hypothesis:** Deeper viewer participation, more organized Q&A sessions, enhanced community connection.
- **Status Tag:** ■ Feature Release
- **Feature Name:** Go Live Together
- **Category:** Engagement & Retention / Collaboration
- **Description:** A collaborative streaming feature allowing creators to invite guests to broadcast with them via a unique link. The host channel benefits from AdSense revenue. Currently in testing for mobile devices.
- **Strategic Intent:** Foster collaboration among creators, enable new content formats (e.g., co-streams, interviews), attract diverse audiences through guest appearances, and encourage creator networking.
- **Impact Hypothesis:** Increased creator networking, broader content appeal, potential for audience crossover, and diversified live content.
- **Status Tag:** ■ Feature Release
- **Feature Name:** Split-Screen Viewing On Mobile
- **Category:** Engagement & Retention / Streaming Infrastructure
- **Description:** A new mobile viewing experience under development where the live chat engagement panel will sit to the right of the screen, replacing the current overlay view.

- **Strategic Intent:** Improve the mobile viewing experience, ensure chat visibility without obscuring primary content, and enhance multi-tasking for viewers.
- **Impact Hypothesis:** Better mobile engagement, reduced viewer frustration, and a more seamless interactive experience on handheld devices.
- **Status Tag:** ■ Feature Release

Monetization Intelligence

- **Feature Name:** Public to Members-Only Livestream Transition
- **Category:** Monetization / Engagement
- **Description:** A new feature enabling channel membership creators to seamlessly transition from a public livestream to a members-only livestream without disruption.
- **Strategic Intent:** Provide creators with more flexibility for premium content, strengthen community bonds with paying members, and attract new paid members by offering exclusive content.
- **Impact Hypothesis:** Increased membership conversions, enhanced value proposition for existing members, and greater control for creators over their exclusive content strategy.
- **Status Tag:** ■ Feature Release

Streaming Infrastructure & Tech Evolution

- **Feature Name:** AI-Generated Highlights
- **Category:** Streaming Infrastructure & Tech / AI Tooling
- **Description:** AI-powered tools capable of automatically generating highlights from live streams, designed for mobile and tablet screens.
- **Strategic Intent:** Reduce creator workload in post-production, provide easily shareable content snippets, and drive discoverability for VODs and short-form content.
- **Impact Hypothesis:** Increased content output, better discoverability for VODs, higher engagement with short-form content derived from live streams, and improved creator efficiency.
- **Status Tag:** ■ Experiment/Beta

Competitive & Strategic Intelligence

- **Feature Name:** Live Rings
- **Category:** Competitive & Strategic / Discovery
- **Description:** A visual cue (rings around a creator's profile picture) designed to alert viewers when a channel is currently live.

- **Strategic Intent:** Increase discoverability and viewership for live streaming content across desktop and mobile, making it easier for viewers to identify active streams.
- **Impact Hypothesis:** Higher click-through rates to live streams, improved real-time audience capture, and enhanced visibility for creators.
- **Status Tag:** ■ Feature Release
- **Feature Name:** Cross-Channel Live Redirects
- **Category:** Competitive & Strategic / Discovery
- **Description:** Expansion of the redirect feature, allowing creators to direct their viewers from a live stream to a live stream hosted on a *different* channel, not just their own.
- **Strategic Intent:** Promote cross-pollination of audiences, facilitate community raids/hosting for external channels, improve discoverability for smaller creators, and foster a more interconnected creator ecosystem.
- **Impact Hypothesis:** Increased viewership for targeted channels, stronger creator collaborations, and enhanced community growth across the platform.
- **Status Tag:** ■ Feature Release

C. Kick No new intelligence to report.

D. Facebook Gaming No new intelligence to report.

E. Others No new intelligence to report.